

Hunter Pons

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EDUCATION

California State Polytechnic University, Humboldt

MA Academic Research in Psychology

Expected Summer 2026

- Social Psychology Emphasis
- Advisor: Amber Gaffney, Ph.D.

Brigham Young University-Hawaii

BS Psychology: General/Experimental

APR 2021

- Certificate in Criminal Justice

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Guest Lecturer — PSYC 335 Social Psychology

Spring 2026

- Designed and delivered lectures; facilitated discussion; organized exam review sessions; provided individualized academic support

Guest Lecturer — PSYC 342W Application of Research Methods in Psychology

- Taught an undergraduate lab on creating effective Qualtrics surveys, covering survey design and best practices

Teaching Mentor — PSYC 336 Social Influence & Persuasion

Fall 2025

- Supported student learning through office hours, exam review sessions, answering emails, and personalized academic assistance.

Mini Lecture — 511 Social Neuroscience

- Designed and presented a 30-minute lecture on social cognition in autism spectrum disorder to a class of ~30 students

Mini Lecture — 647 Academic Research Professional Development Seminar *Fall 2024*

- Designed and presented a 20-minute lecture on attribution theory to demonstrate teaching ability

Article Presentations — Social Identity Lab

Fall 2024-Spring 2026

- Gave 30-60 minute presentations every semester on academic articles relevant to social identity, self-categorization, and uncertainty identity theory to groups of 10-15 undergraduate and graduate students

Volunteer Financial Self-Reliance Course Facilitator

Fall 2019

- Facilitated free weekly group discussions with 4-10 undergraduate students on financial literacy and related topics

Volunteer English Teacher

OCT 2013-AUG 2015

- Designed and implemented free weekly English classes for native Korean speakers

COURSES PREPARED TO TEACH

- PSYC 100 - Psychology of Critical Thinking
- PSYC 104 - Introduction to Psychology
- PSYC 109 - Introduction to Psychological Statistics
- PSYC 240 - Foundation of Research Methods in Psychology
- PSYC 302 - Psychology of Prejudice
- PSYC 322 - Learning and Motivation
- PSYC 335 - Social Psychology
- PSYC 336 - Social Influence and Persuasion
- PSYC 342W - Application of Research Methods in Psychology
- PSYC 641 - Research Methods: Philosophy and Design (Lab)

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Psychology

- Research Methods: Philosophy and Design
- Research Methods: Evaluation
- Regression/Multivariate Topics (Current)
- Analysis of Variance

- Advanced Social Psychology
- Social Influence and Persuasion
- Social Psychology
- Quantitative Research Methods
- Motivation
- Abnormal Psychology
- Learning and Motivation
- Social Neuroscience
- Behavioral Psychology
- Community Mental Health

Criminal Justice

- Issues of Terrorism
- Criminal Investigation and Criminology

PUBLICATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Pons, H. S. (2026, May). The influence of dissenters and social control on consensus and entitativity. Poster presented at IdeaFest, California State Polytechnic University, Humboldt, Arcata, CA.

Benefiel, J. P., **Pons, H. S.**, Burtch, C. E., Anjewierden, B. J., & Gaffney, A. M. (2025, April). *When leaders fall: The role of leader support in post-election collective action*. Poster presentation at the annual conference of the Western Psychological Association, Las Vegas, NV, USA.

Hinojosa, C. E., Burtch, C. E., **Pons, H. S.**, Anjewierden, B. J., & Gaffney, A. M. (2025, February 20-22). Leadership and polarization across the 2020 and 2024 US presidential elections [Poster presentation]. SPSP 2025 Annual Convention, Denver, CO, United States.

ACADEMIC RECOGNITION

Graduate

CPS Scholars General Assistantship Award applied to Thesis Research *Spring 2026*
Graduate Studies Professional Development Award

Undergraduate

Merit Scholarship

Fall 2017, Fall 2019–Winter 2021

Psychology Department Scholar

Fall 2019

David O. McKay Award

Winter 2016

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant — Cal Poly Humboldt

AUG 2024–Present

Social Identity Lab (SI Lab) | Department of Psychology

- Principal Investigator: Amber M. Gaffney, Ph.D.
- Attended weekly lab meetings, led teams of undergraduate students, wrote and prepared conference poster applications, and gave oral presentations

Research Assistant/Analyst — University of Utah

JUNE 2021–AUG 2023

Utah Registry of Autism and Developmental Disabilities (URADD) | Autism and Developmental Disabilities Monitoring (UT-ADDM) Network - Department of Psychiatry | U of U School of Medicine

- Conducted CDC-funded public health surveillance of autism spectrum disorder (ASD) as a full-time research assistant and data abstractor
- Extensive input and data cleaning experience with the REDCap data web application
- Designed a site-specific REDCap abstraction template for individualized education plans (IEP) across multiple school districts
- Updated a systematic review of research on autism prevalence in American Indian/Alaska Native (AIAN) populations
- Created an educational slideshow on the genetic etiology of ASD for the URADD website

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social identity and social influence; social cognition in autism; the influence of election processes on intergroup relations; social control; motivations for group membership; intergroup contact.

REFERENCES

Amber Gaffney, Ph.D.

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